

9 — Logging: \$inspect

DEVELOPER TOOLS

Q. How do you automatically log the old and new values of a state variable every time it changes for debugging?

ANSWER. When an object is changing unexpectedly and breaking your UI, manually writing `console.log()` inside every single update function is exhausting. You drop the `$inspect` rune into your component and pass it the broken variable. Svelte acts as a security camera, automatically logging the exact old and new values every time it shifts.

App.svelte

```
<script>
  let count = $state(0);
  let user = $state({ role: 'admin' });

  // Logs automatically on any change
  $inspect(count, user);
</script>
```

DEVELOPER CONSOLE

```
> $inspect initialization
count: 0  Object { role: "admin" }

> count updated
count: 1  Object { role: "admin" }
```

i Summary. Drop `$inspect` into any component to watch your variables. This is incredibly handy because it acts as a built-in debugger. It automatically prints out the exact old and new values to the console every single time your state changes.